condemned it as reactionary. The habitual and persistent supporters of Government have had to combine criticisms of it with their usual genuflections. Others have been more vehement.

In view of these proposals the Liberals found it difficult to retain in full measure their abiding faith in the inscrutable wisdom of Providence in placing India under British dominion. They offered strong criticism, but disdainful of reality and enamoured of phrases and fine 'gestures', they laid the greatest stress on the absence of the words "Dominion Status" from the Report and the Bill. There was a great outcry about this, and now that Sir Samuel Hoare has made some kind of a statement on the subject, honour will largely be satisfied. The Dominion Status may be an insubstantial shadow haunting an unknown future—a Never-Never land which we may never reach, but we can dream about it at least and grow eloquent over its many beauties. Sir Tej Bahadur Sapru, troubled perhaps by doubts about the British Parliament and the British people, has sought refuge in the Crown. Eminent lawyer that he is, he has laid down a novel constitutional doctrine: "Whatever the British Parliament and people may or may not do for India," he said, "over and above them stood the Crown that looks after the interests of Indian subjects and India's peace and prosperity."[1] It is a comforting doctrine which saves us from troubling ourselves about constitutions, laws, and political and social changes.

But it would be unfair to suggest that the Liberals have lessened their opposition to the scheme. Most of them have made it perfectly clear that they prefer present conditions, bad as they are, to this unwanted gift that is being thrust on India. Beyond stressing that, their very principles forbid them from doing anything, and it may be presumed that they will go on laying stress. For their motto they might well have that modern adaptation of an ancient saying: "If at first you don't succeed, cry again!"

A certain hopeful reliance is placed by Liberal leaders, and probably by many others including some Congressmen, on the victory of the Labour Party in Britain and the formation of a Labour Government there. There is absolutely no reason why India should not endeavour to go ahead with the co-operation of advanced groups in Britain, or should not try to profit by the advent of a Labour Government. But to rely helplessly on

[1] Speaking at a public meeting at Lucknow on January 29, 1935.